# HIST 210: American History 1865-Present

**Instructor:** Prof. James R. Fitzgerald

**Semester:** Fall 2026, begins September 1

**Class Meeting:** TR 11:00-12:30 PM, Humanities Building 405

## Course Description

This survey course examines major themes and events in American history from Reconstruction through the present day. We will explore industrialization, immigration, wars, social movements, and cultural developments that have shaped modern America.

## Course Objectives

- Analyze primary and secondary sources critically
- Understand multiple perspectives on historical events
- Connect past events to contemporary issues
- Develop strong historical writing and argumentation skills

## Grading Components

| Component | Percentage |
|---|---|
| Participation and Discussion | 20% |
| Short Essays (2) | 30% |
| Midterm Exam | 20% |
| Final Research Paper | 30% |

# Weekly Schedule

## Week 1-2: Reconstruction and Industrialization

Topics: Reconstruction policies, Civil Rights Act of 1875, rise of industrial economy

**Assignment due Friday of Week 2: Reading reflections**

## Week 3: Immigration and Urban Growth

Topics: Immigration waves (1880s-1920s), urbanization, industrial working conditions

**Essay 1 due Friday: "Immigration and Labor in Gilded Age America"**

## Week 4-5: Progressive Era and Reform

Topics: Theodore Roosevelt, conservation, trust-busting, women's suffrage movement

No major assignments this week

## Week 6: America and World War I

Topics: U.S. neutrality policies, entry into WWI, home front mobilization

**Midterm Exam due Thursday of Week 6**

## Week 7: The Roaring Twenties

Topics: Jazz Age, consumerism, Prohibition, cultural conflicts

Reading: Fitzgerald selections

## Week 8: The Great Depression

Topics: Causes of economic collapse, Hoovervilles, social consequences

No midweek deadline; work on research papers

## Week 9-10: New Deal and Franklin D. Roosevelt

Topics: WPA, Social Security, changing role of government

**Essay 2 due Friday of Week 10: "Analyzing a New Deal Program"**

### Week 11: World War II

Topics: U.S. isolationism, Pearl Harbor, home front, Holocaust awareness, atomic bomb

Prepare for final paper research presentations

### Week 12-13: Cold War Beginnings

Topics: Iron Curtain, Korean War, McCarthyism, nuclear anxiety

**Research paper outline and bibliography due Friday of Week 12**

### Week 14: Civil Rights Era

Topics: Brown v. Board, Montgomery Bus Boycott, voting rights, Vietnam War opposition

No specific assignment date this week

### Week 15: Modern America (1970s-Present)

Topics: Watergate, end of Cold War, 9/11, globalization, recent political polarization

**Final research paper due Friday: "A Historical Analysis of [Your Topic]"**

## Important Dates

- First day of class: Tuesday, September 1, 2026
- Labor Day (no class): September 7
- Thanksgiving break: November 24-28 (no class)
- Final exam period: December 7-18

## Policies

**Attendance:** Regular attendance is crucial. Two unexcused absences are tolerated; three or more will impact your participation grade.

**Late Work:** Essays and papers will be marked down 5% per day late without documented extension.

**Office Hours:** Prof. Fitzgerald, M/W 1:00-3:00 PM, Humanities 407; email: j.fitzgerald@university.edu